



City Council November 3, 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MxU-7FVaJDA
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Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie City Council

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The meeting transcript does not indicate any statutory public hearings or committee work sessions held immediately prior to the call to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order, opening with the Pledge of Allegiance and an invocation.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Hendershot, Selby, Macintosh, Green, Powell, Garrett, Fishman, Gulian, Mason.
 - **Members Absent:** *None explicitly noted.*
 - **Presiding Officer:** Council President Mason.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**

- 00:00:11 Pledge of Allegiance led by members of Boy Scout Troop 22 from St. Andrews Presbyterian Church.
 - 00:00:46 Invocation delivered by Father David Hailman.
 - 00:01:53 Moment of silence observed in memory of Mary Stilts.
 - 00:02:34 Citizens Recognition Award presented to Rick Ziggler (recognized by Councilperson Noah Powell) for his community contributions, including the Muncie Memory Spiral and the Three Trails music series.
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - 00:13:14 Motion made and seconded to approve prior meeting minutes. Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:14:04 Beach Grove Cemetery Board Vacancies

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Troy Waters, Superintendent of Beach Grove Cemetery.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Waters announced two vacancies on the cemetery board following a passing and a resignation. He clarified that board members must be lot owners and Delaware County residents, and that no political balance is legally required for this specific cemetery governance model.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation only; no formal board action taken.

00:18:17 Committee Reports (Youth Center Committee)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council Member.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Update provided on the multi-neighborhood committee for a youth center, noting outreach to five neighborhood associations and awaiting final selections before convening.

00:19:40 Ordinance 33-25: Vacation of Alley

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:19:40 Ordinance 33-25: An ordinance vacating a part of an alley located in block 15 of T.H. Kirby's addition to the city of Muncie, Indiana.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced by Council.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Brief call for public comment with no speakers responding.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by Roll Call Vote.

00:20:56 Ordinance 34-25: Zoning Amendment (100 N. Hudson Ave.)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:20:56 Ordinance 34-25: An ordinance to amend the city of Muncie comprehensive zoning ordinance from a split zone of R3 and R4 to R3 residence zone for premises located at 100 North Hudson Avenue.

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced by Morin Walby (Power of Attorney for property owner/son).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Walby explained the zoning split caused a tax parcel confusion that has since been resolved, and noted the zoning board approved the change.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Morin Walby spoke in favor during the hearing.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Voice Vote.

00:22:59 Ordinance 35-25: Additional Appropriations (Police Dept.)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:22:59 Ordinance 35-25: An ordinance for additional appropriations, Muncie Police Department.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chris Degan, Muncie Police Department.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Degan requested funds from Public Safety Fund 106 to cover Public Employees' Retirement Fund (PERF) pension contributions for the remainder of the year and capital equipment (four hybrid Ford police vehicles). Council discussed staffing levels and vehicle procurement via state contract pricing.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Resident Cameron Grubs questioned why the funding wasn't drawn from EDIT funds, prompting staff clarification that public safety LIT funds are department-specific and utilized from year-end balances.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Voice Vote.

00:29:23 Ordinance 36-25: Additional Appropriations (Fire Dept. EMS)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:29:23 Ordinance 36-25: An ordinance for additional appropriations, Muncie Fire Department EMS.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Burford.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Chief Burford requested \$260,000 from Fund 104 (Center Township EMS fund) for overtime to finish the year and \$329,521 for a new ambulance equipped with power-load and power-cot systems. Council commended the department for reduced overtime spending due to full staffing.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Voice Vote.

00:35:49 Ordinance 37-25: Elected Officials Salaries (2026)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:35:49 Ordinance 37-25: An ordinance fixing the salaries for all elected officials of the city of Muncie, Indiana for the year 2026.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced by Council.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion touched on past instances where certain appointed positions exceeded maximum salary caps, prompting council and administrative discussion on improving oversight for future salary ordinances.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Voice Vote.

00:40:07 Ordinance 38-25: Appointed Officers & Employees Salaries (2026)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:40:07 Ordinance 38-25: An ordinance amending ordinance 16-25 fixing the maximum salaries of each and every appointed officer, employee, deputy, and assistant departmental and institutional head of the city of Muncie, Indiana included herein for the year 2026.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced by Council.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Technical review of maximum salary caps for city employees aligned with the adopted 2026 budget.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Voice Vote.

00:41:58 Ordinance 39-25: Fire Department Salaries (2026)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:41:58 Ordinance 39-25: An ordinance fixing the maximum salaries of each and every member of the Muncie Fire Department of the city of Muncie, Indiana for the year 2026.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced by Chief Burford / Council.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reflects negotiated raises incorporated into the 2026 budget.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Voice Vote.

00:43:22 Ordinance 40-25: Council Rules - Prerequisites for Filing

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:43:22 Ordinance 40-25: An ordinance of the city of Muncie amending section 32.39 of the city of Muncie code of ordinances prerequisites to action and ordinance resolution action.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Legal Counsel.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Legal counsel explained the ordinance reorganizes council filing rules and adds a substantive requirement: ordinances or resolutions must be filed in person or by email by the sponsoring council person or legal counsel to ensure authorization and prevent unauthorized signature duplication (addressing recent controversy regarding a refiled resolution). Extended debate occurred regarding administrative filing procedures, electronic filing cutoffs, and accountability.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - 00:50:18 Bill Bilbury criticized the council's oversight and read from municipal code regarding investigatory powers.
 - 00:53:48 Mayor Dan Ridenour and legal staff addressed the background of the disputed filing, accepting responsibility for administrative communications.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Failed by Roll Call Vote (5-4 against introduction: Powell, Macintosh, Mason voted yes; Selby, Garrett, Basham, Fishman, Green voted no).

00:14:52 (Recorded Later in Transcript) Resolution 18-25: Promoting Civility & Unity

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 01:14:52 Resolution 18-25: A resolution of the city of Muncie, Indiana recognizing the importance of civility, condemning hateful rhetoric, and promoting unity in community leadership.

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** J.R. Jameson / Council President Selby.
- **Deliberation Summary:** J.R. Jameson presented the resolution, emphasizing the importance of empathy and reducing divisive rhetoric in public discourse. Council discussed the symbolic nature of the resolution and its applicability to board appointments.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by Voice Vote.

00:29:25 (Recorded Later in Transcript) Resolution 19-25: Fire Station Project Financing

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 01:29:25 Resolution 19-25: A resolution of the common council of the city of Muncie, Indiana approving the financing of a fire station project and approving a form of taxpayer petition in connection therewith.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Bond Counsel / Chief Burford / Greg Marts (Developer).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Bond counsel presented the initial financing resolution for rebuilding Fire Station No. 5 (estimated up to \$11,500,000 using a Build, Operate, Transfer / BOT model via a nonprofit building corporation). Council members and the fire union president highlighted the severe deterioration and plumbing/asbestos issues at the current 1960s-era station on Tallyton. Counsel outlined the multi-step process, which includes circulating a taxpayer petition requiring at least 50 valid signatures, a public hearing, and subsequent ordinances.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - 01:46:50 Jason Chaffen (President, Firefighters Local 1348) spoke in strong support, citing recent sewage backups and emergency plumbing repairs at Station 5.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by Roll Call Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 01:58:09 **Bill Bilbury:** Addressed the council regarding the failed transparency ordinance (Ordinance 40-25), criticizing council members for voting against safeguards and urging higher standards of preparedness and oversight.
- 02:02:31 **Ellen Whitehead:** Spoke on Ordinance 40-25, expressing disappointment in the council members who voted against establishing clear procedural standards for self-governance and transparency.
- 02:04:42 **Wayne Scave:** Discussed parliamentary procedure (Robert's Rules), raised concerns regarding the calling of questions cutting off public input, and inquired about empty reserved parking spaces outside City Hall.
- 02:11:04 **Cameron Grubs:** Inquired about the availability of complete audio/video recordings for the recent budget meeting and urged the mayoral administration to embrace civility and transparency.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** *None specifically stated.*
 - **Adjournment:** 02:15:41 Motion to adjourn made and seconded; meeting concluded.
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